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PASSIVE RECONNAISSANCE WITH TRY HACK ME

1.1 Introduction

Important Notice: Please note that if you're not subscribed, the AttackBox won't have Internet access, so you will need to use the VPN to complete the questions that require Internet access.

Answer the questions below

This room does not use a target virtual machine (VM) to demonstrate the discussed topics. Instead, we will query public WHOIS servers and DNS servers for domains owned by TryHackMe. Start the AttackBox and make sure it is ready. You will use the AttackBox to answer the questions in later tasks, especially tasks 3 and 4.

No answer needed

✓ Correct Answer

2.1 Passive verses Active Recon

Passive recon defines where you rely on knowledge from public knowledge and do not necessarily have to meet the target. Active recon , relies on meeting the target or interacting with the organisation.

Question

a)You visit the Facebook page of the target company, hoping to get some of their employee names. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this?

Answer: **Passive Recon**

b)You ping the IP address of the company webserver to check if ICMP traffic is blocked. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this?

Answer: **Active Recon**

c)You happen to meet the IT administrator of the target company at a party. You try to use social engineering to get more information about their systems and network infrastructure. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this?

Answer: **Passive Recon**

Below is a screenshot of all the answers.

Answer the questions below

You visit the Facebook page of the target company, hoping to get some of their employee names. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this? (A for active, P for passive)

P

✓ Correct Answer

You ping the IP address of the company webserver to check if ICMP traffic is blocked. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this? (A for active, P for passive)

A

✓ Correct Answer

You happen to meet the IT administrator of the target company at a party. You try to use social engineering to get more information about their systems and network infrastructure. What kind of reconnaissance activity is this? (A for active, P for passive)

A

✓ Correct Answer

3.1 Whois

You get public information using the whois command.

Question

a) When was TryHackMe.com registered?

Answer: **2018/07/05**

Explanation: I used the kali linux machine to send the whois tryhackme.com command.

Answer the questions below

When was TryHackMe.com registered?

20180705

✓ Correct Answer



```
kali@kali: ~  
Session Actions Edit View Help  
Whois database for failure to abide by these terms of use. VeriSign  
reserves the right to modify these terms at any time.  
The Registry database contains ONLY .COM, .NET, .EDU domains and  
Registrars.  
Domain name: tryhackme.com  
Registry Domain ID: 2282723194_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN  
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.namecheap.com  
Registrar URL: http://www.namecheap.com  
Updated Date: 2025-05-11T14:06:03.00Z  
Creation Date: 2018-07-05T19:46:15.00Z  
Registrar Registration Expiration Date: 2034-07-05T19:46:15.00Z  
Registrar: NAMECHEAP INC
```

b) What is the registrar of TryHackMe.com

Answer: **namecheap.com**

What is the registrar of TryHackMe.com?

namecheap.com

✓ Correct Answer



Which company is TryHackMe.com using for name servers?

```
kali-linux-2025.4-vmware...  
kali@kali: ~  
Session Actions Edit View Help  
Whois database for failure to abide by these terms of use. VeriSign  
reserves the right to modify these terms at any time.  
  
The Registry database contains ONLY .COM, .NET, .EDU domains and  
Registrars.  
Domain name: tryhackme.com  
Registry Domain ID: 2282723194_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN  
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.namecheap.com  
Registrar URL: http://www.namecheap.com  
Updated Date: 2025-05-11T14:06:03.00Z  
Creation Date: 2018-07-05T19:46:15.00Z
```

c) Which company is TryHackMe.com using for name servers?

Answer: cloudflare.com

Which company is TryHackMe.com using for name servers?

cloudflare.com

✓ Correct Answer

```
Tech Phone: 13344212434  
Tech Phone Ext:  
Tech Fax:  
Tech Fax Ext:  
Tech Email: a70a4ff6d25041a48378997194f9e834.protect@withheldforprivacy.com  
Name Server: kip.ns.cloudflare.com  
Name Server: uma.ns.cloudflare.com  
DNSSEC: unsigned  
URL of the ICANN WHOIS Data Problem Reporting System: http://wdprs.internic.net/  
>>> Last update of WHOIS database: 2026-01-30T03:24:17.62Z <<<  
For more information on Whois status codes, please visit https://icann.org/epp  
  
—(kali@kali)~]
```

4.1 Nslookup and dig

Question

Check the TXT records of thmlabs.com. What is the flag there?

Answer: **THM{a5b83929888ed36acb0272971e438d78}**

```
kali-linux-2025.4-vmware...  
kali@kali: ~  
Session Actions Edit View Help  
  
—(kali@kali)~]  
$ dig thmlabs.com TXT  
  
; <<>> DiG 9.20.15-2-Debian <<>> thmlabs.com TXT  
;; global options: +cmd  
;; Got answer:  
;; ->HEADER<- opcode: QUERY, status: NOERROR, id: 61731  
;; flags: qr rd ra; QUERY: 1, ANSWER: 1, AUTHORITY: 0, ADDITIONAL: 1  
  
;; OPT PSEUDOSECTION:  
; EDNS: version: 0, flags: MBZ: 0x0005, udp: 1232  
; COOKIE: 3d941f3c53ad93ce01000000697cbb402b316be734d08821 (good)  
;; QUESTION SECTION:  
; thmlabs.com. IN TXT  
  
;; ANSWER SECTION:  
thmlabs.com. 5 IN TXT "THM{a5b83929888ed36acb0272971e438d78}"  
  
;; Query time: 151 msec
```

Answer the questions below

Check the TXT records of thmlabs.com. What is the flag there?

THM{a5b83929888ed36acb0272971e438d78}

✓ Correct Answer

5.1 DNSDumpster

Lookup tryhackme.com on DNSDumpster. What is one interesting subdomain that you would discover in addition to www and blog?

Answer:remote

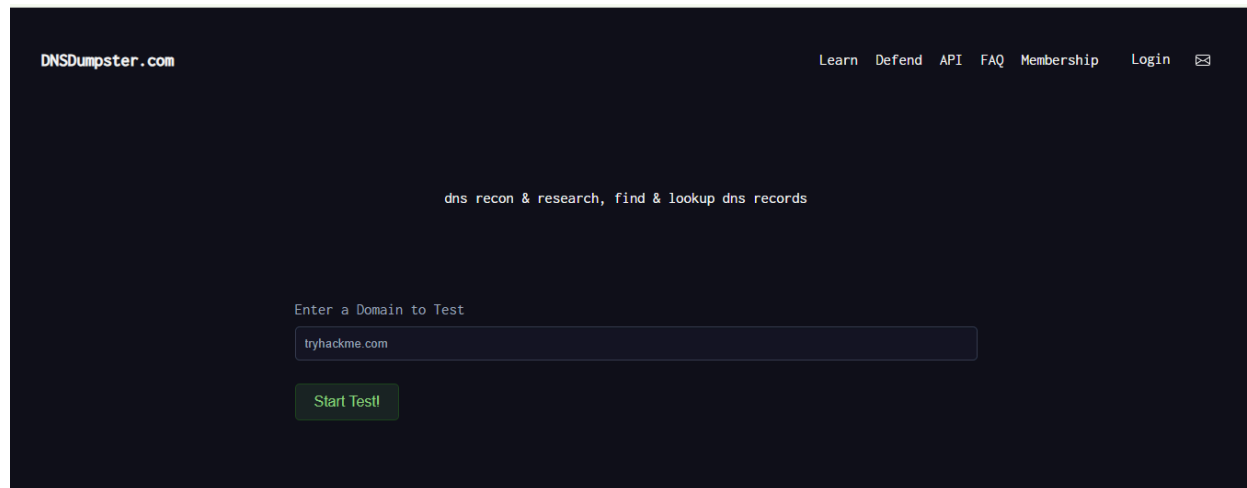
Explanation:While the main **www** site is usually a hardened web server, the **remote** subdomain is a high-value target for hackers because it provides a potential doorway into the internal network.

Answer the questions below

Lookup tryhackme.com on DNSDumpster. What is one interesting subdomain that you would discover in addition to www and blog?

remote

✓ Correct Answer



help.tryhackme.com	172.67.27.10	ASN:32653 128.0.0.0/2	ENETWORKS, ZA United States	http: unknown server tech: Cloudflare http8080: unknown server tech: Cloudflare	5	⋮
insights-proxy- worker.tryhackme.com	172.67.27.10	ASN:32653 128.0.0.0/2	ENETWORKS, ZA United States	http: unknown server tech: Cloudflare http8080: unknown server tech: Cloudflare	5	⋮
remote.tryhackme.com	104.22.54.228		United States	http: unknown server tech: Cloudflare http8080: unknown server tech: Cloudflare	5	⋮
www.tryhackme.com	172.67.27.10	ASN:32653	ENETWORKS, ZA	http: unknown server	5	⋮

6.1 Shodan .io

Question

a) According to Shodan.io, what is the first country in the world in terms of the number of publicly accessible Apache servers?

Answer: **United States**

Answer the questions below

According to Shodan.io, what is the first country in the world in terms of the number of publicly accessible Apache servers?

United States

✓ Correct Answer

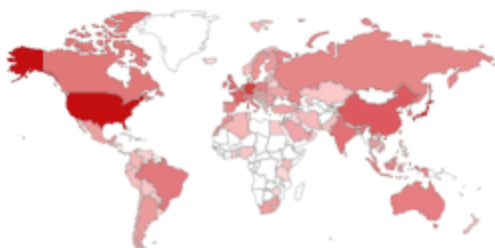


Based on Shodan.io, what is the 3rd most common port used for Apache?

TOTAL RESULTS

15,574,805

TOP COUNTRIES



United States	4,167,200
Japan	1,497,116
Germany	1,484,093
China	719,145
France	650,573

[More...](#)
 View Report

Product S

 ServiceN

16.51.38.95
ec2-16-51-38-95.a
mpute.amazonaws
Amazon Data Serv
Australia, Melb
🔒🔒🐘🐘

cloud

 16.147.12

ec2-16-147-125-20
pute.amazonaws.c
Amazon.com, Inc.
United States,
php

cloud eol-prod

b) Based on Shodan.io, what is the 3rd most common port used for Apache?

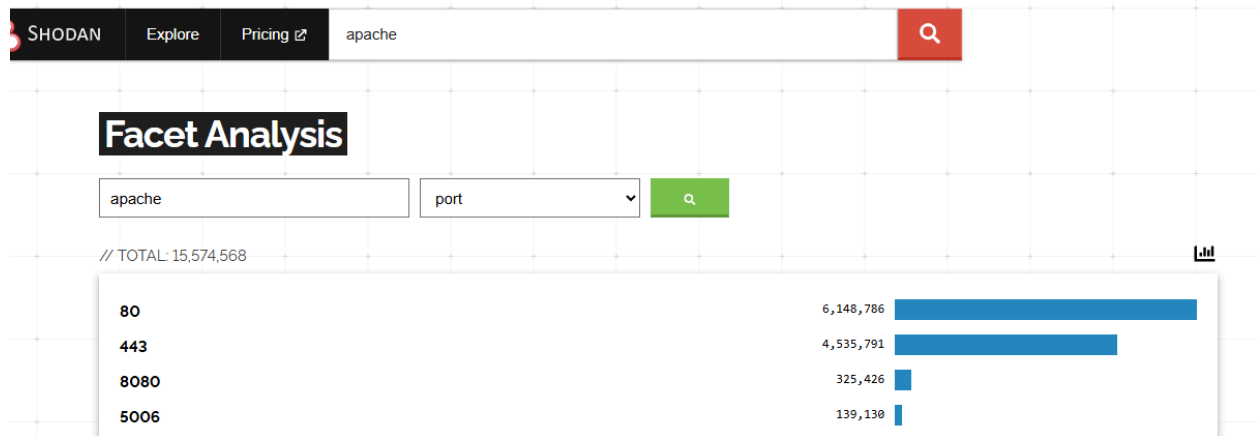
Answer:8080

Based on Shodan.io, what is the 3rd most common port used for Apache?

8080

✓ Correct Answer

?



c)Based on Shodan.io, what is the most common port used for nginx?

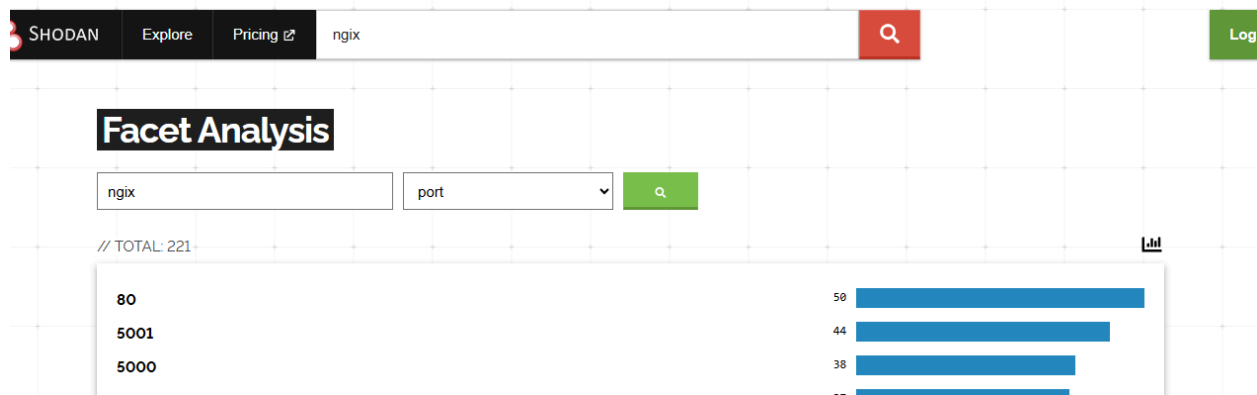
Answer:80

Based on Shodan.io, what is the most common port used for nginx?

80

✓ Correct Answer

?



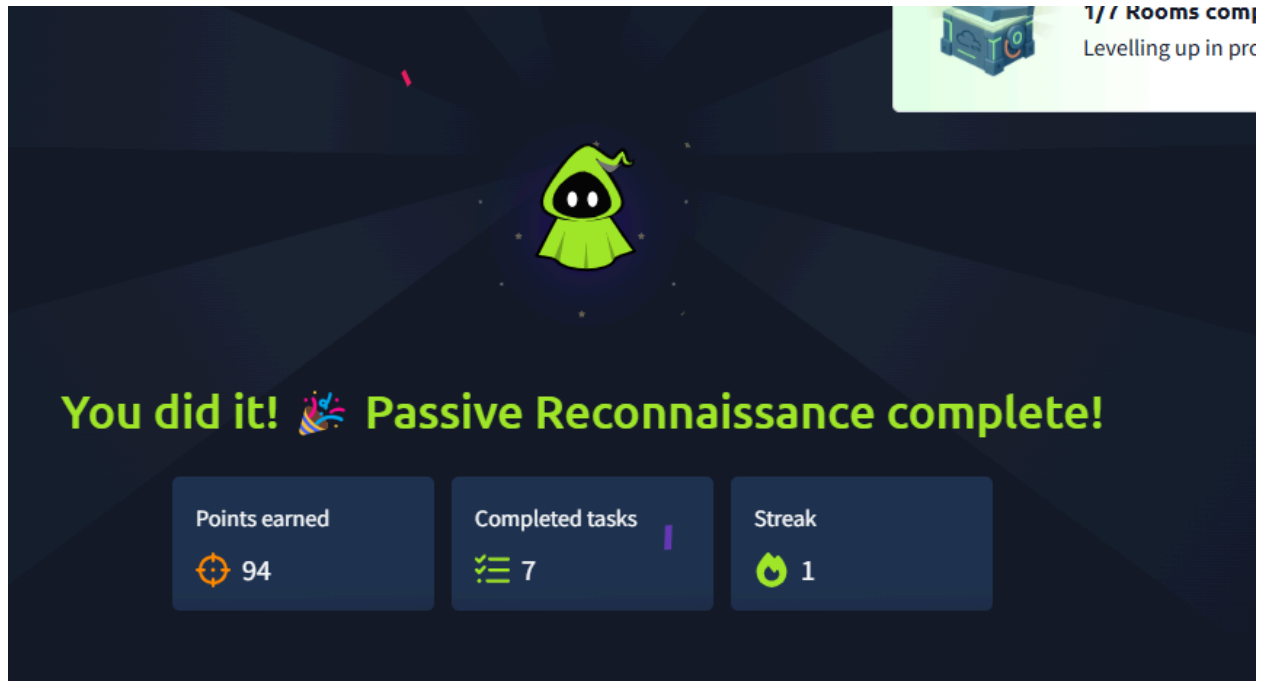
7.1 Summary

No answer needed

8.1 Conclusion

In this module, I learned how much information can be found online. When you search a domain using a tool like Shodan.io, you can be surprised by the amount of data that is publicly accessible. This is known as passive reconnaissance. Active reconnaissance, on the other hand, involves directly interacting with the target systems themselves.

Below is a link and a screenshot of my achievement to this module.



<https://tryhackme.com/p/marynyambura657>

